

DAVE

THE DIVER



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After spending over 100+ hours in Dave the Diver, when I started gathering my thoughts for this review, I had some trouble pinning it down under any one genre. It combines an adventure game into a restaurant management simulator; at a macro level it's a 2D platformer (largely submerged under water) with instances of zooming in really close and delighting as a simulator (where you move your mouse in circles to simulate using a spatula in a saucepan).

Believe it or not, I took the plunge into Dave the Diver on the very first day of Steam's Summer Sale 2023, not knowing what to expect. The game's art and short trailer had me intrigued, I liked the tiny glimpse into what Dave's journey entailed and began playing it in earnest. Running a sushi restaurant by hunting and foraging fish and other essentials from the Blue Hole on a daily basis seemed like an exciting challenge, so off I went.

Playing Dave the Diver and understanding the game's mechanics was extremely easy, as the game has an intuitive and easy-to-navigate interface

that's warm and inviting. My first dive into the game's aquatic environment was accompanied by a calm and serene soundtrack that instantly set the mood for me. In fact, the game isn't graphically advanced, but its music and soundtrack helps set a tranquil yet adventurous atmosphere every time you're playing it. I'll go as far as even saying that the music plays an especially important role in Dave the Diver's gameplay reward, for any gamer who chooses to immerse

themselves into it. As I navigated through kelp forests and coral reefs, dived in a variety of weather conditions, the game's pixelated graphics were nothing short of enchanting, opening an interactive window into an underwater world that we've largely explored through television shows. Dave the Diver's underwater world felt alive with vibrant colours, with all the animated marine creatures living and breathing as they would in the real world. As you start to soak in the ambience of what's on display, the

